

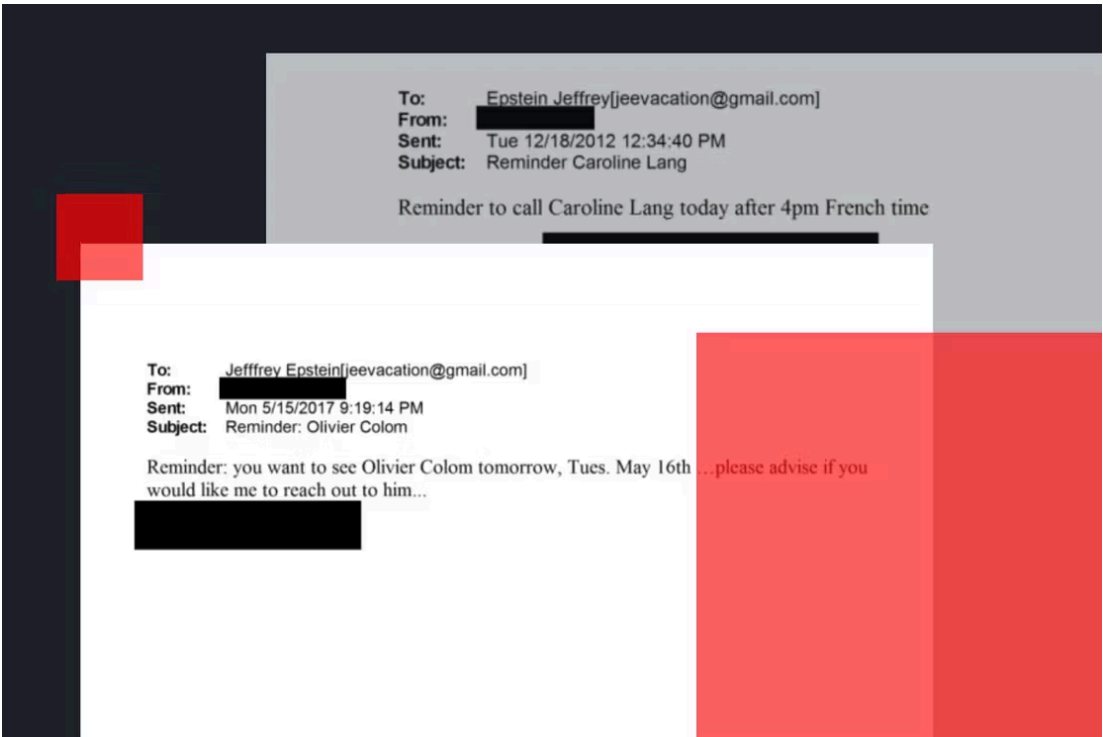
FRANCE JEFFREY EPSTEIN

Epstein's correspondence reveals links to French public figures

Millions of emails released by the US Department of Justice reveal the financier's relationships, some more intense than others, with several figures from France's politics and culture.

By Ivanne Trippenbach
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Excerpts from Jeffrey Epstein's emails, released by the US Department of Justice on January 30, 2026. Montage by Le Monde. MINISTERE AMERICAIN DE LA JUSTICE/LE MONDE

During the 2010s, Epstein was known as a wealthy businessman who made his fortune on Wall Street and was close to Bill Gates and entrepreneurs from Silicon Valley. He had already been accused in 2008 of setting up a system of underage prostitution at his villa in Palm Beach, Florida – the Federal Bureau of Investigation identified 33 victims, some as young as 14. The financier reached a deal with federal prosecutors in Florida, pleaded guilty to soliciting prostitution from just one 14-year-old girl, and negotiated an 18-month prison sentence.